STATEMENT OF PURPOSE

One of the most pivotal moments in my life was on my twelfth birthday, when my parents surprised me with my first personal computer! From the moment I received it, I formed an inexpressible and instant bond with it. I was so thrilled and enthused to have it and went onto quickly learning as much as possible about computer systems. I began gaining insight into the immense potential and power that can be attained through the utilization of computers and computer-related technologies.

My love for everything computer-related encouraged me to pursue undergraduate studies in Information Technology. During my junior year, I went onto creating a Hotel Management System with advanced graphics. I utilized Visual Basic, Java Server Pages, PHP, MS Access and MS SQL to accomplish what I had envisioned for it. This system enabled the hotel staff to seamlessly manage all daily operations. The user interface was developed to be both logical and intuitive, whilst enabling easy accessibility. This encouraged and engaged the staff to better manage the reception, reservations, restaurant, inventory and accounts.

Through my undergraduate studies, I gained exposure to various subjects such as software engineering, database technology and networking concepts. This led me to pursue my senior year project work on an e-learning management system. This included streamlining several functionalities, such as administration, documentation, tracking, reporting, quizzes and exams to and delivery of educational courses and training programs in more effective ways. Contextual research enabled me to focus in on how to better manage and process data collection, and consequently make informed decisions, such as which courses to add based on previous data, and report generation based on the results. I also gained introductory exposure to management-based subjects like Industrial Management, project management where I acquired knowledge and a basic understanding of management concepts and fundamentals.

I was selected as one of the three finalists from a highly competitive pool of 240 applicants for a two-month summer internship prior to my senior year. Working in a team environment with the other two finalists, we focused on developing a software with advanced functionality for digital image processing, Complete Video Solutions for BPCL. My Senior Thesis Report was a survey on Information Security, covering a detailed expanse of all encryption algorithms and security standards. I graduated top of my class with honors in 15 subjects. My professional career thus far in IT has allowed me to develop in many aspects, including managing people in a highly competitive IT work environment, as well learning new technologies, such as SharePoint and SAP to name a few. In my team of 10, I was the only one to receive an outstanding rating and consequently got promoted to Senior Analyst.

I now find myself utterly enthralled and engrossed with computer technology and IT. I spend many an hour exploring, envisioning and experimenting—trying to push beyond the limits of what has been accomplished through their means. Through my highly competitive academic background, as well as professional experience of close to three years at HCL Technologies' headquarters, one of India's most prominent, multinational IT firms, I've discovered an unyielding desire to pursue my graduate studies and further the scope of my professional career. Lately, my intrigue has begun expanding into the realm of specializing in Information Systems Management, specifically Information Systems and Security. I feel a propensity to contribute to the further development of the field itself, in new and innovative ways.

Over the past few decades, the capabilities of and need for both generation and collection of computerized data has been increasing at an alarming pace. This explosive growth in stored data has generated an urgent need for new techniques and tools that can intelligently assist us in the management of data and information. Managing information systems in more efficient and innovative ways will very likely be one of the most thriving frontiers in the information field in the very near future.

After considering several graduate programs, I'm convinced that your robust MISM program at Carnegie Mellon University is definitely the way to go, to advance my passion, intellectual curiosity and of course career path. I'm quite certain that getting accepted by and enrolled into Carnegie Mellon's MISM program will prove to be a mutually beneficial relationship. It has been a long-held dream that upon completing my grad studies from Carnegie Mellon, I'll work towards attaining high caliber leadership roles in some of the

most dynamic companies in the field, before branching out to create my own innovative technologies' firm. With every fiber of my being, I believe that Carnegie Mellon's MISM program would be the first step towards realizing my career dream.

I so look forward to joining you and to proving myself an invaluable asset to the Carnegie Mellon community, both as a grad student and future alumnus.

Prakhar Chaudhary